

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Waiting for the proposal ...



Learning Outcome

Exchange advice and suggestions in a range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- How effective are you at work? Do you have any specific habits?
- When was the last time you had to meet a work deadline? Did you make it?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about people's habits.
- I can leave a phone message.
- I can talk about feelings and reactions.





Let's Explore!

Will Peter finish the proposal in time?



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Janet:** Hi Miranda. Peter's not come in today, has he?
- Miranda:** Nope. I'm not surprised. He seemed pretty put out that we were expected to be here yesterday.
- Janet:** He was certainly smug when the storm did head this way and I announced the office was closing.
- Miranda:** Smug! He tends to be conceited.
- Janet:** Ummm, I suppose you'd have told me if you'd received the proposal from him yet. Doesn't he also have a tendency to come through?
- Miranda:** No and yes. No correspondence from him, but yes, he usually does deliver.
- Janet:** Alright, I guess I do know that. I hardly get bothered by things like this but I'll admit I'm more apprehensive now with so much depending on the deadline.
- Miranda:** Would you feel more relieved if you spoke to him? I can call him.
- Janet:** Why don't you try?
- Answering Machine:** Hello, this is Peter Smith. Sorry to have missed your call. Please leave your message after the beep.
- Miranda:** Hello, Peter. This is Miranda from the office. We haven't heard from you. Hope you're well despite the storm yesterday. It's 11:30 and we're wondering about the state of the proposal. Please give us a call when you get this message. Thank you.
- Miranda:** I hate answering machines.
- Janet:** Go have a coffee. I'll call you if there's news.

Twenty-five minutes later ...

- Janet:** Miranda! There's a fax coming through!
- Miranda:** Peter's proposal! Well, he did make a point of sticking to his word. Five minutes before the deadline - how typical of Peter!



Let's Practice!

Soon robots will help us do many things!

Instructions: Read the message. Complete the message with the missing words below. Read the dialogue aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

give / Peter / office / haven't heard / the state / a call / finish it / Thank / calling

Hello, 1. _____. This is Miranda 2. _____ from the 3. _____. It's 11:30 and we 4. _____ from you yet today. We're wondering about 5. _____ of the proposal and whether you've had time to 6. _____. Please 7. _____ us 8. _____ when you get this message. 9. _____ you.



Let's Practice!

Does Peter stick to his word*?

*To "stick to his word" means to do something he promised to do.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Choose the correct answer. Use the sentences to model a conversation with your partner. Switch roles.

1. He _____ smug.

- a. tends to be
- b. make a point of
- c. points out

2. Doesn't he also have a _____ come through?

- a. tendency to
- b. hardly
- c. made a tendency of

3. He _____ deliver.

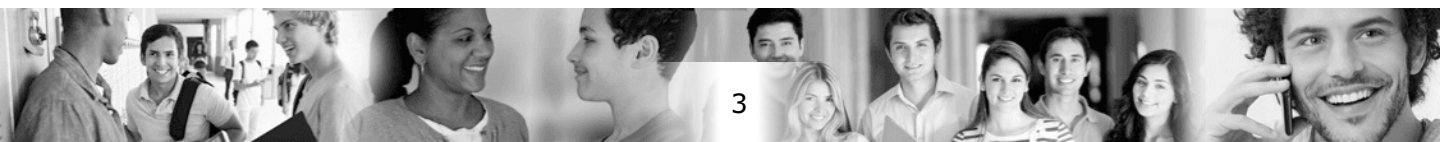
- a. make a point of
- b. usually does
- c. tends to be

4. Well, he did _____ sticking to his word.

- a. points out
- b. a tendency to
- c. make a point of

5. I _____ get bothered by things like this.

- a. tend to
- b. hardly
- c. points out





Extension Activity

Let's leave a message.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Create a short answering machine voice message to use when your partner calls you.
- Think about a problem you are having in the office (for example, your co-worker did not write an e-mail you asked him/her to).
- Create a short voice message to send to him/her.
- Make sure your message includes an introduction, a reason for calling, a request for call back, your contact information, and an ending. If possible, describe the situation using an expression to describe a habit.
- "Call" your partner and read your voice message to him/her.
- When you are finished, switch roles.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I think of a possible problem in the office.

☐ ☐

I write a short and detailed voice message including an introduction, reason for calling, request for a call back, my contact information, and an ending.

☐ ☐

I talk about habits.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to be put out** (verb): to be upset
e.g. Peter was put out that he had to be in the office yesterday.
- **smug** (adjective): looking or feeling too pleased about something you have done or achieved
e.g. He tends to be smug.
- **conceited** (adjective): thinking you are very clever or skillful
e.g. He tends to be conceited.
- **apprehensive** (adjective): worried or frightened that something unpleasant may happen
e.g. I'm apprehensive with so much depending on the deadline.
- **relieved** (adjective): feeling happy because you are no longer worried about something
e.g. I'm relieved that he called!





Learning Points

Talking About Habits

In the business world, it is important to talk about things that are part of your daily life.

Normally, the **Present Simple tense** is used to describe activities you do on a daily basis.

You can use the following expressions to describe habits.

Expression	Verb form	Example
I (often) tend to ...	main verb	He tends to be on time.
I have a tendency to ...	main verb	He has a tendency to meet deadlines.
I usually ...	main verb	He usually meets his deadlines.
I hardly ...	main verb	I hardly feel pressured at work.
I (always) make a point of ...	verb - ing	I always make a point of meeting deadlines.





Learning Points

Leaving a Phone Message

Talking on the telephone can be challenging for a variety of reasons. Firstly, you are not able to see the person you're talking to, so there's no body language to be read. Secondly, it requires a special set of words, phrases, and expressions.

The chart below will help you to leave a message on the phone confidently in business and personal situations.

Voicemail Message	<i>Hello, this is Peter Smith. Sorry to have missed your call. Please leave your message after the beep.</i>
Leaving a Message	Hello, _____ (person's name). This is _____ (your name) from _____ (company).
1. Introduction	Hello, _____ (person's name). This is _____ (your name) from _____ (company).
2. Reason for calling	I'm calling to let you know that ... (clause) I'm calling to tell you that ... (clause) I'm calling because ... (clause)
3. Request for a call back	Please give _____ (name) a call when you get this message. Could you ring me to ... (confirm / discuss / talk about) Could you give me a call back to ... (verb)
4. Contact information	You can call / reach / get me on _____ (number). I'll be in the office until / between / from _____ (time).
5. Ending	Thank you / Talk later / Bye.

Examples:

• *Hello, Mark. This is Mary calling from the HR office. I'm calling because we haven't heard from you. It's 1 pm and we were wondering about the proposal. Please give me a call when you get this message. Thank you!*

